



MARCHERS head for downtown L.A. on May Day. Rallies were held across the country and worldwide. **A2**

Strike threat over ICE at World Cup site

Union proposes labor action at SoFi, saying agents would make for an unsafe workplace.

By Kevin Baxter

Isaac Martinez has been a cook at SoFi Stadium for four years. He's worked dozens of events including NFL games, a Super Bowl, Taylor Swift concerts, Wrestlemania and the college football national championship game.

And he's never been afraid to come to work. Until now.

He's not alone. With the World Cup kicking off at the Inglewood venue next month, Martinez says he and many of the people who work in food services and other jobs at the stadium won't feel safe if federal immigration agents are present during the tournament. "Most of the workers are afraid. They fear for their safety," Martinez said in Spanish. "This is also about the fans. People come from everywhere, even from Iran. So we're concerned about their safety."

So concerned that Unite Here Local 11, the hospitality union that represents Martinez and about 2,000 others who are working at SoFi without a contract, said it may strike ahead of the World Cup if Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents aren't kept away from the stadium. Last month Unite Here Local 11 filed an unfair labor practice complaint with the National Labor Relations Board charging Legends Hospitality, which operates the premium food, beverage and retail services at SoFi; Kroenke Sports and Entertainment, owner of the stadium; and FIFA, organizer of the World Cup, with creating an unsafe work environment by refusing to restrict the presence of ICE officials at the eight World Cup games [See World Cup, A8]

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Police will soon be able to ticket robotaxis

By Karen Garcia

Driverless cars haven't always obeyed the rules of the road but, unlike vehicles with humans behind the wheel, they've gotten away with it.

That's about to change.

A slew of statewide autonomous vehicle regulations based on Assembly Bill 1777 will go into effect July 1 — including a process for law

enforcement to issue a "notice of AV noncompliance," the California Department of Motor Vehicles announced Tuesday.

Here's how this new law will work, and what other rules self-driving vehicle manufacturers will soon have to follow:

The new regulation was developed "to address the gap in how moving violations are handled for autonomous vehicles," said Jona-

than Groveman, a DMV spokesperson.

Although California is home to several autonomous vehicle operators, the most expansive at this point is Waymo, which has driverless robotaxis navigating passengers around the San Francisco Bay Area and dozens of L.A. County cities.

Seven months ago, a self-driving Waymo made an illegal U-turn at a traffic light right in front of police

officers in San Bruno.

The image of an officer peering into the empty driver's seat of the vehicle may have been good for a chuckle, but other incidents have been no laughing matter. Situations such as a Waymo failing to stop for a school bus in Atlanta or striking a child in Santa Monica highlighted how officers couldn't carry out traditional traffic enforcement [See Driverless, A8]

LAPD wants to increase staffing for the Olympics

More officers are needed, department says

By Libor Jany

A request from Los Angeles police officials to boost staffing and purchase new vehicles in time for the 2028 Olympic and Paralympic Games has been met with deep skepticism by City Council members who worry about committing funding amid uncertainty around the plan to secure the venues.

During an hours-long budget hearing Tuesday, LAPD Chief Jim McDonnell repeated a warning he has issued in recent months, suggesting that public safety will suffer if the city doesn't hire more officers to replace the hundreds expected to leave the department in the next two years.

Despite recent recruitment gains, McDonnell said the council needs to fund the new hires now, so the department can staff up in time for the Olympics. Under the current security plan, the LAPD would supply about 2,400 officers, or just under a third of the total officers needed to police the Games.

The Los Angeles Police Department is requesting 520 new recruits for the next fiscal year, which would grow the 8,600-member department by about 10 officers, with projected attrition at 510 officers.

The department is also requesting

nearly \$100 million from the city to purchase more than 500 new vehicles, as well as equipment such as an upgraded radio network, new computers and more than 1,600 body cameras, for the Games. LAPD officials said that after the Games, the vehicles would be used to upgrade the department's aging fleet.

LAPD Cmdr. Mario Mota told council members at the Tuesday hearing that hundreds of the new vehicles would police the eight Olympic venues within city boundaries. The additional patrol cars and other specialized vehicles would also allow police to continue normal operations elsewhere over the 66 days between the July 14 start of the Olympic Games and the end of the Paralympic Games, he said.

LAPD officials said there was a misconception that federal authorities will take the lead on all security operations at Olympic venues. In fact, the federal priority will be safeguarding international delegations and protecting high-security areas, while the LAPD and other state and local agencies will be responsible for securing areas where most Olympic-re-

[See Olympics, A8]

'Red boxing' in a heated bout

By Seema Mehta

Intriguing updates emerged on Democratic gubernatorial candidate Xavier Becerra's campaign website this week.

Highlighted in bright red text, and boxed by a red outline, was a game plan for attacking one of Becerra's top rivals in the California governor's race, billionaire hedge fund founder turned environmental activist Tom Steyer.

But was that message meant for California voters or, perhaps, a more specific audience — the operatives running the newly formed big-money independent committees that are backing his campaign?

Becerra's website may be using a practice known as "red boxing," a nod to how campaigns signal what they want outside groups supporting them to focus on in [See Becerra, A7]

Bright outlined text on Becerra's website underscores increasingly testy race for California governor



ERIC THAYER Los Angeles Times

CODED messages and other tactics used on Xavier Becerra's website have raised an outcry but are legal.

Iran's defiance limits Trump's options for an offramp in war

Administration faces legal and diplomatic pressure. Support lags for unpopular conflict.

By Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — More than 60 days into his war with Iran, well past public deadlines he had set for its end, President Trump sat through a briefing from U.S. Central Command outlining yet another set of options for a fresh round of strikes.

On offer Thursday were unpalatable choices for a president eager to move on from the conflict he started. Renewed U.S. attacks risk inflaming the war beyond Trump's control, undermining a fragile ceasefire for which American allies fought hard. But the very need for such a briefing underscored how difficult a position the president has found himself in.

A legal deadline for congressional authorization arrived Friday that threatens to increase pressure on the administration — and underscore lagging support for the most unpopular U.S. war in modern times. Global oil prices remain above \$100 a barrel entering the midterm election season. And a diplomatic breakthrough with Tehran appears nowhere in sight.

Signs pointed to another U.S. military buildup in the

region this week that could portend a fresh round of fighting. A U.S. Defense official familiar with the matter said the U.S. military has used the weeks-long pause to replenish its munitions. So, too, have the Iranians, who have reportedly increased their efforts to dig out stockpiles of missiles and drones buried by U.S. and Israeli strikes.

"Amateurs look at strategy; pros look at logistics," said Robert Pape, a professor of international relations at the University of Chicago. "I have seen more buildup of force — actual firepower, with the addition of a third aircraft carrier, and logistics — than we've seen since the beginning of the war in February. So there's been a notable change in the past week."

The logistical surge appears to be a stream of Boeing C-17 military transport aircraft making their way to the region, alongside the addition of a third aircraft carrier. Only two carriers were in place when Trump launched the war Feb. 28.

"That's a pretty good sign that they're mobilizing," Pape added. "These are strategic and operational indicators. I would imagine they're looking for a sharp knock."

More than 10,000 Marines from expeditionary units are now in theater, giving Trump the option to launch limited ground operations, [See Iran, A4]

Google among tech giants to sign AI deals with Pentagon

Defense Department said agreements would help make military an 'AI-first fighting force.'

By Queenie Wong

Eight technology companies, including Google, Nvidia and SpaceX, have struck deals with the Pentagon to help the U.S. military gain an edge on the battlefield.

"These agreements accelerate the transformation toward establishing the United States military as an AI-first fighting force and will strengthen our warfighters' ability to maintain decision superiority across all domains of warfare," the Department of Defense said Friday.

The companies will deploy their AI technology on the department's "classified networks" for "lawful operational use," according to the agency.

OpenAI, Microsoft, Amazon Web Services, Oracle and AI startup Reflection are among the companies that agreed to work with the Pentagon.

The agreements underscore how tech companies

are expanding their work with the U.S. military even as some workers raise concerns about the use of AI for autonomous weapons and mass surveillance. Anthropic, the San Francisco company behind the chatbot Claude, clashed with the Pentagon earlier this year over whether there were adequate safeguards around the military's use of its technology.

The Department of Defense accused Anthropic of trying to "seize veto power" over military decisions, though the company pushed back against that characterization. The agency labeled Anthropic a supply chain risk, and the Trump administration directed federal agencies to stop using the company's tools, setting off a legal battle over that designation.

This week, hundreds of Google employees urged Chief Executive Sundar Pichai to reject use of its AI systems for classified workloads to ensure that its technology isn't used in "inhumane or extremely harmful ways." Harmful use may occur without their knowledge since the work is classified, workers said in the letter.

Google, Reflection and [See Pentagon, A12]

Court blocks mailing of mifepristone

Federal ruling requires that the abortion pill be distributed only in person at clinics. **NATION, A6**

Historic Latino political triumph

Whittier's City Council result signals a broader trend, Gustavo Arellano writes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Low clouds, then sun. L.A. Basin: 75/57. **B8**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**

Iamaleava poised for huge season

Conditions are ideal for UCLA's quarterback to thrive, Mirjam Swanson writes. **SPORTS, B12**

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